
I am a 15-year-old girl. Let me show you the vile misogyny that confronts me on social media every day | Anonymous

Published by

Estimated reading time

6 min

Added on

2026-02-23

Address

<https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2026/feb/23/15-year-old-girl-misogyny-social-media-online-abuse>

I am a 15-year-old girl. Let me show you the vile misogyny that confronts me on social media every day | Anonymous

If you're anything like my parents, you probably wouldn't even understand most of the content that floods my social media, no matter how hard [I try to avoid it](#).

Here's a recent example from Instagram: "Do y'all females ever tell ur homegirls 'Sis chill you letting too many dudes hit?'" Essentially, that means: "Women – do you ever tell your girlfriends that they're whores and need to stop letting so many guys fuck them?" The reel, posted by a 19-year-old man, appeared on my Instagram feed without me wanting to see it, or ever interacting with any other similar content. The comments that followed were pure misogyny. "Women see body count as a leaderboard and they try to outdo each other," was one of them. Translation: all women are competitively promiscuous.

Consider the use of the word "female" in these posts. It is not a neutral term here, it is a term of abuse. It's used by teenage boys to degrade us and equate us to animals. Boys are never described as "males", but girls are always "females" – the equivalent of sows or calves, creatures that are less than human. We're also "thots" (whores), "community pussy" and "bops". "Bop" stands for "been over passed" and is a derogatory term used by boys to refer to a girl they've decided has been "passed around" or had too much sex. Sexual equality has ceased to exist online. It's absolutely fine for boys to have sex, but when girls do, they are called worthless and referred to as objects. "When community pussy tries to insult me, I just want to beat that bitch up." That's a message I saw on TikTok.

I'm a 15-year-old schoolgirl and like most teenagers I spend a fair portion of my spare time on social media, often scrolling through short-form videos on apps such as Instagram or TikTok. All of my friends use those apps, and many spend multiple hours a day on them. I actively try to avoid online misogyny, but I am met with it incessantly whenever I open my mainstream social media apps. It only takes a few minutes before there's subtle or overt misogyny, such as comment sections on a girl's post filled with remarks about her body, videos made by men or boys captioned with a degrading joke, and even topics such as domestic violence or rape, trivialised and laughed about.

A few days ago I saw an Instagram reel of a young woman talking about how she had been raped six years ago, struggled with thoughts of suicide afterwards, but managed to rebuild her life again. Among the comments – the majority of which were from men – were things like "Well at least you had some", "No way, she's unrapeable", "Hope you didn't talk this much when it happened", "Bro could have picked a better option." Reading those comments, which had thousands of likes and many boys agreeing with them, made me feel sick.

If a girl my age posts any video of herself online, the comments section will be filled with objectifying and hateful remarks about her, regardless of what the topic of her post was. If she wears anything revealing, or just happens to have larger breasts, she'll be abused and sexualised. Completely unprompted, there might be hundreds of comments insulting specific features she may have, or rating her attractiveness out of 10. "Sub5", for example, describes someone who is below 5/10 in attractiveness. I've seen videos of boys telling anyone who is unattractive that they should end their own life.

Despite the sexual ways in which boys my own age describe us online, there is also an extreme emphasis on female purity and virginity. Sex is often called as "cracking" by my age group, where

men do the cracking and women get cracked. "Body count" – referring to the number of times someone has had sex – is used only to degrade women. A girl with a "high body count" is "used up" and no longer has value. "You can always tell if she's ran through," one boy said on Instagram.

Often it feels like we're hated not only if we're sexual but simply for existing. I would be lying if I said I wasn't affected by seeing boys my own age post things about women like: "Men are objectively superior in pretty much every conceivable metric," and "They are just devils that imitate feelings so we feel empathy." Words such as "bitch" are the least of it. One of the worst labels is "foid" – originally from incel subculture but now becoming mainstream – which refers to women as being less-than-human, female humanoids.

And what is the effect? If I spend even 10 minutes on an app such as Instagram, I will close it, feeling disheartened and unhappy about being a girl. When nearly every comments section on a video of a girl my age is filled with disgusting and objectifying comments about her body from boys, it causes me to feel deeply uncomfortable in my own body, and compare myself to her; especially if she is beautiful and still being deemed unattractive. Endless emphasis on beauty as worth and all kinds of videos criticising specific features, some of which I possess, have made me start to loathe my own face, as difficult as that is to admit. But the worst thing is knowing how much hate there is from men and boys for all women and girls, including me.

Using social media has ruined my self-esteem and my relation to being a girl in this world, and nearly every day I feel hatred towards my gender, my appearance, or even teenage boys as a category. The misogyny I see from boys my age online, which is echoed in real life too, has made me grow resentful and bitter towards them, as much as I try to avoid it. As wrong as it is, I persistently find myself considering if there are truly any boys out there who are not misogynistic to some extent, and have even questioned whether I can find love in the future because of this. I understand that boys are victims of harmful content, as well as [perpetrators of online misogyny](#) – they're growing up learning how to do this from the adults who post misogynistic videos first. But even so, I feel such a strong divide now between girls and boys in my generation, especially when the way they talk about us in real life mirrors the way they do on the internet.

I can't speak for every girl my age, but I frequently feel objectified, dehumanised and disgusted by the hate towards women I see online, and I can say with certainty that most of my friends would agree with me. A [social media ban for under-16s](#) might prevent young boys seeing endless content that treats women with contempt and hate. Boys at this age are very susceptible to the cool and funny framing of what is, in reality, relentless misogyny. A ban might not fix the problem, but it would help. If society can't stop it, it can show it disapproves.

-

The writer is an anonymous teenage web user

-

In the UK and Ireland, [Samaritans](#) can be contacted on freephone 116 123, or email jo@samaritans.org or jo@samaritans.ie. In the US, you can call or text the [National Suicide Prevention Lifeline](#) on 988, chat on 988lifeline.org, or [text HOME](#) to 741741 to connect with a crisis counselor. In Australia, the crisis support service [Lifeline](#) is 13 11 14. Other international helplines can be found at befrienders.org

- *In the UK, [Rape Crisis](#) offers support for rape and sexual abuse on 0808 802 9999 in England and Wales, 0808 801 0302 in [Scotland](#), or 0800 0246 991 in [Northern Ireland](#). In the US, [Rainn](#) offers support on 800-656-4673. In Australia, support is available at [1800Respect](#) (1800 737 732). Other international helplines can be found at ibiblio.org/rcip/internl.html*

- ***Do you have an opinion on the issues raised in this article? If you would like to submit a response of up to 300 words by email to be considered for publication in our [letters](#) section, please [click here](#).***

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.